

Lola Loom

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling intended to purchase a family-owned ceremonial textile you had borrowed for your installation, despite your refusal to sell.

What you are hiding

The textile is in the exhibition without the full paperwork your family expected because you were afraid the loan would be denied. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Imogen's unreleased performance idea and the gala's closing spectacle look suspiciously similar.
- Julian has been using intermediaries to buy back some of his own early paintings.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Avery photographed you repairing a hanging thread in the gallery continuously through the key window.

IF MURDERER

You brought a textile swatch to Sterling at 6:46, poisoned his drink, and left a distinctive thread on the tray.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

The textile in my installation belongs to my family, and I brought it into the exhibition before every piece of loan paperwork was settled. Sterling wanted to buy it despite our refusal. That is what I was hiding. Julian and Imogen watched me repairing the installation while the poison was added.

IF MURDERER

Sterling treated a family object like everything else in his orbit: if he wanted it, refusal was merely a price negotiation. I brought him a swatch, poisoned his cordial, and left a thread behind on the glass. I wanted him to understand that not everything beautiful is available for purchase. I chose an unforgivable way to make the point.

Investigation notes
